

FOCUS AREAS

- Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW), Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC)
- AI-Mediated Communication, Human-AI Interaction, Future of Work

EDUCATION

University of Washington

M.S. in Human Centered Design & Engineering (HCI)

GPA: 4.00 / 4.00

Seattle, WA, USA

Sep 2025 - Jun 2027 (expected)

University of Toronto

Honours B.A. with High Distinction, Sociology and East Asian Studies

Capstone: *Voice of the Customer* for Pune Municipal Corporation, India

Exchange: University of Tokyo

Toronto, Canada

Sep 2019 - Jun 2024

Sep 2023 - Apr 2024

Jan 2022 - Jun 2022

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Examining Students' Use of LLMs for Interpersonal Communication in Academic Settings

Jan 2026 - present

Lead Researcher, University of Washington

Designed and led an IRB-approved two-phase interview study (12 participants, digital-whiteboard elicitation, 110 recipient-channel groups consolidated into 31 contexts) on why and how students hand academic messages to AI; extending to $n = 17$ for a full manuscript. [[p.2](#), [n.2](#), [m.1](#)]

Understanding Interns' Experience of AI Uncertainty and Its Effects on Mental Well-being

Sep 2026 - present

Lead Researcher, University of Washington

Critical incident technique study of how interns decide whether to delegate work to AI and whether to disclose it; team paper targeting CHI 2027 Posters. (in progress)

Investigating Professional Visual Artists' Use of Generative Agents for Creative Work

Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

Lead Researcher, University of Washington

Led a 4-person team through an interview study with 5 professional artists on creative identity, authorship, and agency as generative AI enters their workflow; built a 68-code codebook in ATLAS.ti and framed the contribution distinguishing proactive, principle-based limits from reactive, quality-based fixes. [[p.1](#)]

TraceQual: An AI-Disclosure Tool for Qualitative Analysis

Apr 2026 - Jun 2026

Independent Project, University of Washington

Built a Python tool on the Anthropic Messages API that reads a researcher-AI transcript and produces a structured decision matrix of analytic choices for a methods appendix; versioned schema, rule-derived confidence model, four-state validation harness, Streamlit deployment path. github.com/jaredren/tracequal

Building an LLM-Powered Dispute-Classification Tool for Wikipedia Moderators

Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

Directed Research Group, University of Washington

Parsed and hand-labeled 170+ talk-page discussions to the relevant Wikipedia policy, essay, or guideline; validated inter-rater agreement and fine-tuned a GPT-4.1 mini model in Python; delivered a working prototype for moderator testing.

Participatory Mapping of Food-Access Program Awareness at Neighborhood Farmers Markets

2026

Research Volunteer (supervisor: Dr. Elin Björling), University of Washington

Co-designed a "map your route" activity and sticker cultural probes to surface market-goers' awareness of EBT, SNAP Market Match, and Fresh Bucks; collected and analyzed 26 participant worksheets; scaling the method toward a participatory-design poster and a community handoff blueprint.

Usability Evaluation of Anchor for an Industry Sponsor

Jan 2026 - Mar 2026

Co-lead, 4-person team (HCDE 517), University of Washington

Cognitive walkthrough, heuristic review, and a moderated end-to-end usability test with 7 participants; delivered 9 ranked issues and presented findings to the sponsor.

Voice of the Customer: Amplifying Urban Voices Through City Archives

Sep 2023 - Apr 2024

Senior Capstone, International Multidisciplinary Urban Capstone Project, University of Toronto

Four-discipline team designing a communication and data-visualization platform to capture community voices for Pune Municipal Corporation, India; framed requirements and design criteria, built the design matrix of alternative archive designs, and led front-end deliverables (user survey, low- and high-fidelity wireframes, prototypes, partner presentation, poster).

PUBLICATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED POSTERS AND EXTENDED ABSTRACTS

- [p.2] **Jared Ren** and Soobin Cho. 2026. "ChatGPT, Review This Message to My Prof" Investigating Students' Use of AI for Online Communication in Academic Settings. In *Companion Publication of the 2026 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW Companion '26)*, October 10–14, 2026, Salt Lake City, UT, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 4 pages.
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3785651.3831512>
- [p.1] **Jared Ren**, Manasvi Kale, Hsiang-Yi Lung, and So Eun Choi. 2026. "I Can Talk to AI, but the Making Is Mine" Professional Artists' Use of Generative Agents for Creative Work. In *14th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction (HAI '26)*, November 16–19, 2026, Osaka, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA. (to appear)

NON-PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [n.2] **Jared Ren** and Soobin Cho. 2026. Delegating Before Learning: Where Generative AI Sits in Students' Professional Communication. [arXiv:2608.28837](https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.28837) [cs.HC] (accepted at the 2026 **CSCW workshop** 'Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication')
- [n.1] **Jared Ren**. 2026. An Account of Contribution Dissolution in a Research Team. Preprint to appear [cs.HC] (accepted at the 2026 **CSCW workshop** "Nobody Did This": Contribution, Originality, and Accountability in Agent-Mediated Collaboration')

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

- [m.1] **Jared Ren** and Soobin Cho. Full-length manuscript extending [p.2] (interview sample n = 17). Target: *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* (**CSCW**), submission December 2026.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Seattle City Light

Seattle, WA, USA

Continuous Improvement Intern, Customer Experience Division

Jun 2026 - Sep 2026

Publicly owned electric utility, City of Seattle

- Owned the residential rebate process documentation and streamlining project: go-and-see interviews across four stakeholder teams, three validated iterations of swimlane and value stream maps, and an A3 with six countermeasures, each with an owner and a 30/60/90 plan; adopted as the baseline for ongoing improvements.
- Facilitated two cohorts of lean improvement training (8 staff each, 16 contact hours) for engineers, people leaders, and field workers, and coached each participant's improvement project; each cohort identified about \$50,000 in annual savings.
- Coded survey responses from 29 staff across 16 divisions into eight themes with reach metrics and Likert statistics; authored the summary report for leadership.
- Planned and ran a full-day 5S improvement event at the Skagit hydroelectric project; handed the visual standard, audit checklist, and sustain plan to the on-site owner.

Canada Revenue Agency, Government of Canada

Junior UX Researcher, Service Innovation and Strategy

Strategy & Service Design Research Intern

- Conducted 50+ interviews, focus groups, surveys, and card sorts with small-business taxpayers on a 2-person research team; senior management built the recommendations into the next quarter's mandate.
- Co-designed, with a senior officer, a filing-responsibility decision tree used by 1,000+ business filers; validated the structure with tree testing, raising task success 66% and reducing front-line call volume.
- Sole owner of the division's SharePoint information architecture: research, restructure, launch, and weekly upkeep as primary page manager; intranet traffic rose 25%.
- Built, with a senior officer, a divisional KPI dashboard and process maps across business units; developed onboarding materials and organizational mapping; mentored the section's intern.

Canada

Jun 2024 - Aug 2025

Jun 2023 - May 2024

Orcasound × The Whale Museum

UX Research Intern

- Conducted discovery research for the redesign of the "Sound of the Salish Sea" bioacoustics exhibit, representing the nonprofit Orcasound: stakeholder interviews, structured field observation (AEIOU), and intercept interviews across two site visits.

Friday Harbor, WA, USA

Mar 2026 - Aug 2026

Kontech Insights

UX Research Intern

- [Add one or two bullets: study types run, deliverables, and clients.]

Vancouver, BC, Canada

Feb 2023 - May 2023

HomeOptions

Operations Intern, 3-person operations team

Real-estate technology startup

- Designed a HubSpot CRM integration and built an automated lead-generation pipeline (Airtable population, form fill, contact emails); daily leads rose from about 20 to about 100.

Remote

Jun 2021 - Dec 2022

HONORS AND AWARDS

Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award, University of Washington

Fall 2026

HCDE BS/MS Conference Fund Travel Award, University of Washington

Fall 2026

Honours B.A. with High Distinction, University of Toronto

Jun 2024

Munk Student Excellence Award, University of Toronto

Kakehashi Project Award, Japan-funded cultural exchange

Dean's List Scholar, University of Toronto

Winter 2023

Language Citation in Chinese, University of Toronto

Winter 2021

PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

ACM CSCW 2026 (Poster Session): Poster and lightning talk [p.2], Salt Lake City, UT

Oct 2026

CSCW 2026 Workshop (Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication): Talk [n.2]

Oct 2026

CSCW 2026 Workshop (Nobody Did This): Lightning talk [n.1]

Oct 2026

HAI 2026 (Poster Session): Poster [p.1], Osaka, Japan

Nov 2026

Capstone Field-Research Presentation: Community-based study for Pune Municipal Corporation, Pune, India

2024

Cultural-Exchange Presentation: Japan exchange program, Tokyo, Japan

2022

VOLUNTEER AND COMMUNITY SERVICE

Seattle Asian American Film Festival (SAAFF): Usher and Accessibility Volunteer	2026
Seattle City Light Family Day: Registration and Check-in Volunteer	2026
Neighborhood Farmers Markets, Seattle: Community Research Volunteer	2026

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Qualitative methods: semi-structured interviews, focus groups, thematic analysis and codebook development, contextual inquiry, field observation (AEIOU), intercept interviews, participatory and community-based design, cultural probes, card sorting, tree testing, usability testing (moderated, cognitive walkthrough, heuristic evaluation)

Quantitative and process methods: survey design, Likert and SUS instruments, descriptive statistics, lean process mapping, value stream mapping, A3 problem solving, 5S

Programming and tools: Python (pandas, matplotlib, Plotly), LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI), LLM fine-tuning, Git/GitHub, Jupyter, ATLAS.ti, draw.io, Excel, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, Streamlit

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (intermediate), Japanese (intermediate), French (conversational)